

Multi-Step Fraud Schemes Cheat Sheet

Stepwise Tactics

1. Build Trust

- Pretend to be familiar or credible

2. Create Urgency

- Act quickly! It's urgent

3. Use Authority

- "This is an order from the CEO"

Outcome

- Money stolen, data compromised

Red Flags to Watch

-  Multiple small requests that escalate
-  Sudden urgency or secrecy
-  New "authorities" introduced
-  Asking for sensitive info over time

Patterns to Watch

-  Step-by-step: Trust  Urgency  Authority  Exploit
-  Emotional triggers: Fear, Pressure, Trust
-  Inconsistent emails or instructions

Quick Reflection

Remember: Pause & Verify!

- Have these requests been building up?

- Am I pressured to act fast?

- Could this be part of a bigger scam?

Think before you respond—multi-step scams build up slowly. Stay alert! 